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AI



Benchmark in talks to lead Series A for Greptile, valuing AI-code reviewer at \$180M, sources say

[Greptile](#), an AI-powered code review startup, is in the process of raising a Series A. Sources familiar with the deal tell TechCrunch it's for \$30 million at a \$180 million valuation led by Benchmark partner Eric Vishria. But one person says that the deal hasn't closed and terms may change.

Founded by Daksh Gupta after he graduated from Georgia Tech in 2023, the startup went through Y Combinator in the winter of 2024 cohort, and raised a [\\$4 million seed round](#) led by Initialized Capital after completing its program.

Gupta told TechCrunch [last year](#) that the bot his company developed acts as an experienced coworker, possessing a deep understanding of the customer's code, which enables it to pinpoint bugs and other potential issues that human reviewers might miss.

As with most areas of AI, the code review space is very competitive.

Greptile's most prominent rivals include Graphite, a startup that earlier this year raised a [\\$52 million Series B](#) led by Accel with participation from [Anthropic's Anthology Fund](#) with Menlo Ventures, a16z, and others. Another key competitor is [CodeRabbit](#), which last year secured a \$16 million Series A from CRV.

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The intense competition has driven Greptile to require its staff to work exceptionally long hours.

The then 22-year-old Gupta [posted on X](#) in November that Greptile “offers no work-life-balance.” Employees typically work from 9 am until 11 pm, including Saturdays, and sometimes Sundays, he wrote.

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After the post went viral, Gupta told multiple news outlets that outperforming the competition demands maximum effort from every team member. “No one cares about the third-best company, or even the second-best company in any category in software. If you’re going to put in 95 percent effort, it’s the equivalent of putting in 0 percent effort,” [Gupta said in an interview with Inc.](#)

Whatever the work culture, attracting an A-list VC like Benchmark at a healthy Series A valuation could also be helpful in Greptile’s journey.

Greptile and Benchmark did not respond to a request for comment.

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Marina Temkin

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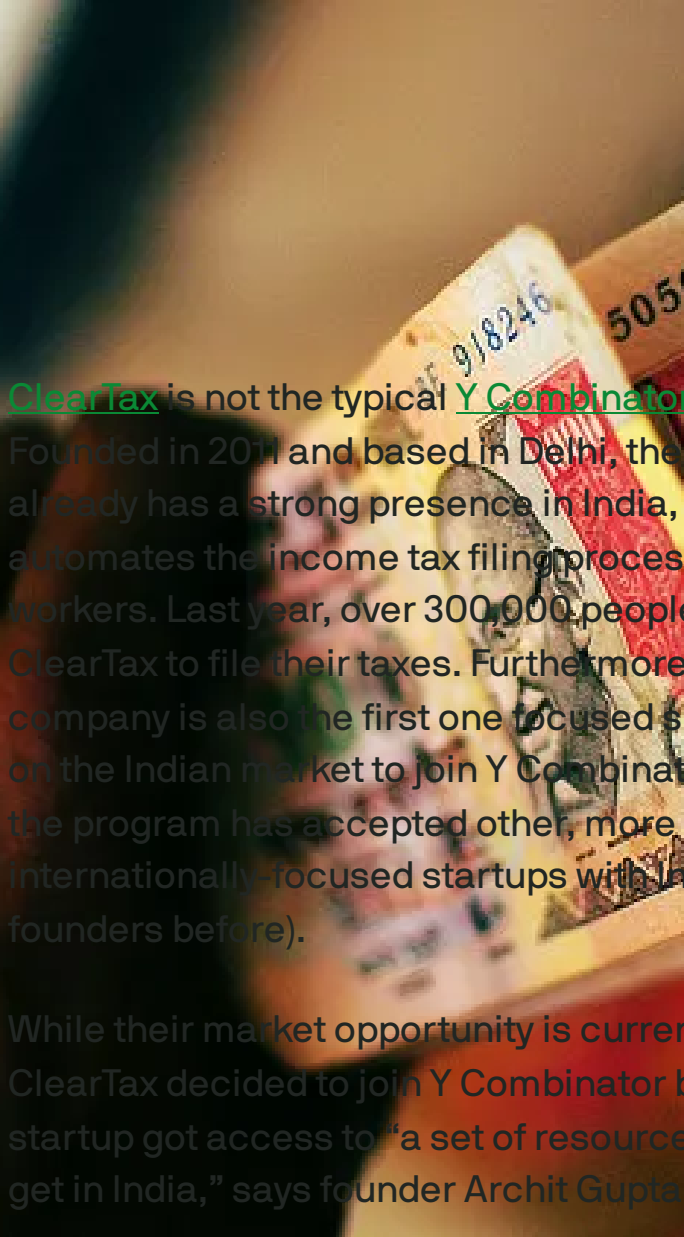
Marina Temkin is a venture capital and startups reporter at TechCrunch. Prior to joining TechCrunch, she wrote abo...

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YC-Backed ClearTax Tackles India's Fast Growing Online Tax Filing Market



ClearTax is not the typical [Y Combinator](#) launch. Founded in 2011 and based in Delhi, the startup already has a strong presence in India, where it automates the income tax filing process for workers. Last year, over 300,000 people used ClearTax to file their taxes. Furthermore, the company is also the first one focused specifically on the Indian market to join Y Combinator (though the program has accepted other, more internationally-focused startups with India-based founders before).

While their market opportunity is currently in India, ClearTax decided to join Y Combinator because the startup got access to “a set of resources we don’t get in India,” says founder Archit Gupta.

“We were missing some of the mentorship in India for example. I worked in Silicon Valley before. I was an engineer at [Data Domain](#), which was acquired by EMC. So I had seen how being in the Valley is super useful, so that whole thing made it very, very clear to us that we should come out here.”

Since it’s currently tax season in India, ClearTax’s nine-member team has split their time between California and Delhi. Gupta started ClearTax with his father Raja Ram Gupta, a chartered accountant; Srivatsan Chari; and Ankit Solanki.

India’s Push To Get All Tax Filings Online

ClearTax wants to expand beyond India eventually, says co-founder Archit Gupta, but right now there

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the country presents a fast-growing opportunity thanks to the government's goal of making all tax filings online by 2016, which means that 42 million people will be filing their income taxes electronically in about a year. Furthermore, four million new taxpayers join the workforce every year and the projected rate of increase in the number of e-filers is 9% year over year.

"Twenty million filed online a couple years ago, 27 million last year, and I think it will be 30 to 35 million this year," says Gupta. "For us, that's one of the very key drivers of growth. It's basically forced by the government saying we want everything electronic."

E-filing in India is already six years old and there are several other companies that offer online tax services. To differentiate, ClearTax decided to look at e-filings as a "software problem," says Gupta. They also created a simple user interface with a slightly irreverent tone to mitigate the tediousness of filing taxes.



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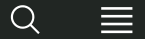
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“Before we existed, before ClearTax existed, nobody, I think, had taken a look at the tax filing product like from a software perspective,” says Gupta.

India’s version of the W2 form is called Form 16, or F-16. To use ClearTax, all someone needs to do is upload the form onto the website. Then ClearTax’s software automatically pulls out relevant data, so

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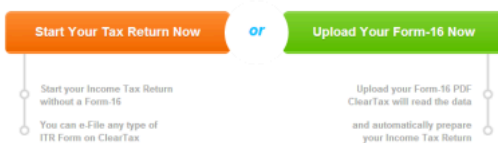
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ClearTax’s competitive advantage is making the process of filing taxes easier and faster, with less

steps and potential headaches for individual users, says Gupta. For example, if someone has a question about certain field in their tax form, they can leave it blank and then ask one of the 70 chartered accountants ClearTax works with for help.

How ClearTax Gets Users

While the startup's business model is B2C, it uses a B2B model to find users by reaching out to large corporations, which then offer ClearTax for free or at a discount to their employees. These companies currently include the Royal Bank of Scotland, as well as major startups like InMobi and Flipkart.

Unless someone gets an employee discount from their company, self-filing costs between \$4 to \$5, while an assisted filing, in which a user gets help from a certified public accountant, costs \$10 to \$100 depending on the product and complexity of the tax return.

One of ClearTax's biggest growing markets are Indian citizens living in other countries, who have a [service made specifically for their needs](#) that costs \$40. Another is ClearTax's products for businesses, which are currently targeted toward freelancers and small businesses. Most of ClearTax's enterprise clients are freelance photographers or work in tech-oriented industries, including web design and development. ClearTax's accountants help them claim expenses, which in turn can increase the amount of their tax return, by asking them questions with a phone call.

Gupta says that ClearTax has a "strong partnership with the government in the sense that they give us the APIs and then they are pretty hands off. They don't get involved, they don't try to. It's pretty good a relationship with the government, so we actually

think the government is focused on making things simpler for the country.”

Growing Beyond Tax Filings

After 2016, when all tax filings are online if the government’s initiative goes according to plan, Gupta says ClearTax will start working on software-driven personal finance products.

“We don’t just want to get into selling off funds or investment instruments. There has to be a value addition via software, like [WealthFront, the fin-tech company Adam Nash is helping to build](#) that says it will use software to tell people how to invest and it will have a very small carry and just be mutual funds. That to me is a much more exciting model and it’s a very new way of thinking.”

In the near future, ClearTax will focus on building mobile software, including tools that will allow people to file their income taxes using only their phone. Gupta says much of ClearTax’s website traffic already comes from people browsing on their Android devices.

“Next year, we will crack the code in getting people to file on their phones because we can do optical-character recognitions. Once someone uploads a photo of their F16 or emails it to us, it’s really a very small amount of data,” says Gupta. “We see a very strong rise in Android traffic on our website and we know it’s very important for us to be there for our users in that aspect.”

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Catherine Shu

Senior Reporter | X Home

Catherine Shu covered startups in Asia and breaking news for TechCrunch. Her reporting has also appeared in the...

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Evabot secures fresh capital to inject AI into corporate gifting

Kyle Wiggers — 6:00 AM PDT · July 28, 2022

The idea of corporate gifting to maintain client relationships isn't a novel concept. In fact, there's a cottage industry of "gifting-as-a-service" startups that promise to streamline the task, ranging from companies such as [Reachdesk](#) and [&Open](#) to [Sendoso](#) and [Goody](#). Vendors claim their industry is a profitable one (worth an [estimated](#) \$258 billion) because the evidence suggests corporate gifting works. One [study](#) found that 66% of people who received a promotional product or gift could recall the brand that sent it, and 79% would be likely to do business with the company again.

But according to Rabi Gupta, the co-founder of [Evabot](#), there's "a lot of clutter" in the corporate gifting space. He argues that many vendors do little more than send company-branded swag like T-shirts and thermoses, which don't exactly foster loyalty. In one recent [survey](#), companies cited the inability to purchase from multiple brands, managing inventory and storage, and the limited range of products as their top challenges where it concerned gifting.

Evabot itself is a vendor. But Gupta asserts that the company's AI-driven approach, which uses a chatbot to poll potential gift recipients about their likes, preferences and lifestyles to personalize presents, is more effective than most.

Investors agree. Today, Evabot announced that it raised \$10.83 million in a funding round led by Comcast Ventures with participation from Alumni Ventures, Bloomberg Beta, Precursor Ventures, Forefront Venture Partners and Silicon Valley Bank. Gupta said that the proceeds will be used to scale Evabot's operations, product development and growth, as well as its investments in AI to build "fully automated" gifting experiences.

"Every enterprise wants to really 'know' their customers and employees so as to be able to

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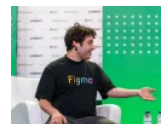


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create thoughtful experiences and touch points. Every enterprise cares about building relationships but they need to do that at scale,” Gupta told TechCrunch via email. “Since most of us are remote now, businesses need a better way to connect with their customers and employees.”

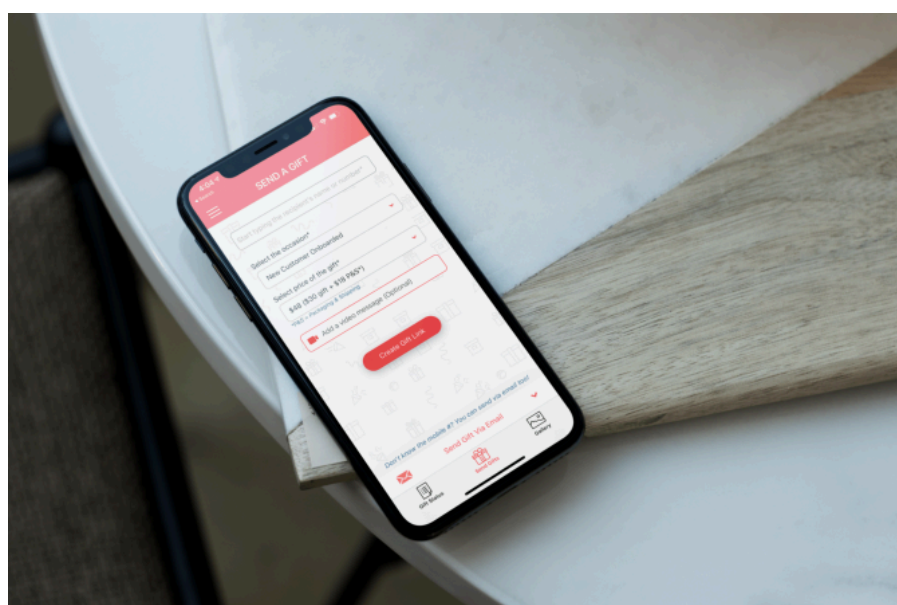


IMAGE CREDITS: EVABOT

Gupta co-launched Evabot, which previously went by the name Vizzi, in 2016 with Satwick Saxena, Ashish Kumar and Akshay Gupta shortly after they immigrated to the U.S. Prior to Evabot, Rabi Gupta, Kumar and Akshay Gupta worked together at India-based iCouchApp, a social app for discussing TV shows and channels.

Like other corporate gifting platforms, Evabot provides an array of gifting services ranging from holiday and birthday gifts to employee onboarding items. To autofill details like names and contact information, Evabot connects to customer relationship and HR systems like Salesforce and Workday. Once recipients finish a questionnaire sent via the aforementioned chatbot, Evabot automatically selects and mails the gift — complete with a handwritten note.

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Evabot rival [Alyce](#) uses AI, too, to plug into various apps and track relationships to personalize gift recommendations. But Rabi Gupta says that Evabot leverages AI in a variety of ways, not just for gift suggestions.

“[Gifts are] picked by our AI based on the data collected and attributes like past gift ratings, weather in a location, gift budget, and more,” Rabi Gupta said. “[To create the] personalized note that’s added to every gift, we use the data collected by our AI and the natural language generation tool [GPT-3](#). Evabot also collects birthdays from the gift recipients, and then data like this becomes a trigger for the sender to send another gift or a thoughtful note or email.”

Rabi Gupta tells TechCrunch that the business model is a combination of software-as-a-service subscriptions and per-gift revenue. It’s pricing that’s proven attractive — Evabot has shipped more than 125,000 unique gifts to date for over 1,000 customers, including health services giant Cigna. Most of the gifts come from “artisanal” direct-to-

consumer brands and local vendors, Rabi Gupta says.

But what of future growth? The corporate gifting market had a rosy [outlook](#) as of 2020, when a poll found that 54% of companies planned to increase their investment in gifting over the next two years. Despite Rabi Gupta admitting that he's seen a "slowdown," Evabot's co-founders believe the company is in a position to perform despite the headwinds.

"There is definitely some short-term slowdown [in the corporate gifting space] since companies are slowing down hiring ... But overall, we are seeing very strong interest from enterprises who care about long-term relationship building," Rabi Gupta said. "Before raising our Series A, we were profitable. Right now, we have two years of runway, and the idea is to get to profitability and scale 4x within the next 18 months."

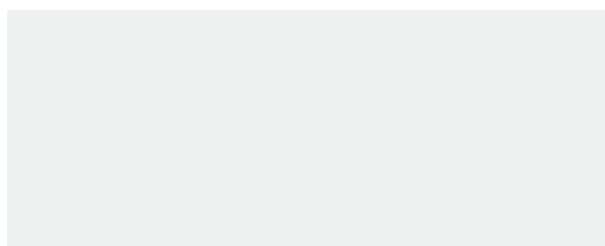
Evabot has raised a total of \$13.83 million in capital to date, which includes a previously undisclosed \$3 million seed round. The company employs 60 people across offices in San Francisco, Dallas, and cities in Canada and India, a headcount Rabi Gupta intends to grow to 70 by the end of the year.

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Kyle Wiggers was TechCrunch’s AI Editor until June 2025. His writing has appeared in VentureBeat and Digital...

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